Dear Quillstone Payments Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Machine Learning Engineer – Customer Support AI role. My experience combines applied machine learning, experimentation and analytics in a customer-focused subscription business, and I am now looking to deepen my experience taking machine-learning systems further into production.

At Thistlebox, I built a weekly demand forecasting workflow using LightGBM, with scheduled notebook runs writing forecasts to BigQuery for operations to use in Looker. The work reduced WAPE from 23% to 14%, with estimated food waste down 9%. I also developed a weekly XGBoost churn-scoring workflow to target retention offers; a 10% holdout validated a 2.1 percentage-point reduction in churn in the treated group. These projects involved feature engineering, data workflows and evaluating results against business outcomes.

I have also built a Streamlit sequential A/B testing calculator used by around 25 colleagues, and wrote its Dockerfile; the data platform team handles its Cloud Run deployment. I bring strong Python and SQL skills, experience with BigQuery and dbt, and have been adding pytest unit tests to forecasting feature code, now at approximately 60% coverage. My MSc in Statistics provides a strong foundation in modelling and uncertainty.

Quillstone's AI team brings together engineering, data science and product to move ideas from prototype to production and build tools that help merchants get support quickly. That combination of applied modelling and close product and engineering collaboration is a compelling next step for me. Thank you for considering my application; I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could contribute to the team.

Kind regards, Tobias Mwangi-Hartley